SOE KIT

The British Special Operations Executive (SOE) trained and equipped hundreds of secret agents. Many were parachuted into enemy-occupied territory, wearing the outfit shown, to support and coordinate local resistance groups. Aircraft carrying the agents were sometimes guided to safe dropping zones by agents on the ground equipped with a portable transceiver, the S-phone. Agents were also equipped with compasses and maps to find their own way if they for some reason failed to link up with a "reception committee" awaiting their arrival.



SOE jumpsuit
Designed for use by covert-action personnel parachuting into occupied territory, the camouflaged suit protected the clothing (worn underneath) from damage, and had numerous pockets in which to hold vital equipment. Once on the ground the agent would quickly remove the suit and disappear into the night wearing local dress. From then on the agent would live and work ostensibly as an ordinary member of the community into which he or she was deployed.

SOE SPECIAL FORCES BADGE

S-Phone transceiver unit
A miniaturized transmitter and receiver, the S-Phone weighed only 7kg (15lb). The agent could use it to speak to the pilot of an aircraft 64km (40 miles) away flying at 3,050m (10,000ft).